The *Lawoe*, we may recall, was sold to P. Easwaramurthia Pillai in 1911. As the port of registry continued to be Tuticorin and given that Easwaramurthia is a typical Tirunelveli Saiva Vellalar name, it is likely that he was a Tuticorin-based merchant. Who was he, and why he bought the *Lawoe* is not known. As his name does not figure in other records, we do not know if SSNCo owed him any dues. In any case, the very next year he sold it to Hajee Tar Mahomed Ayoob. The *Lawoe* then passed into the hands of Dada Mia Khandwani in 1913. Sadly, the *Lawoe*, the workhorse of SSNCo, was reported missing, in 1917, during World War I.[3]

Such was the fate of the *Gallia* and the *Lawoe*, described by Bharati as VOC's adorable daughters. Did the news of their eventual fate reach VOC? What thoughts crossed his mind? Did he shed a few tears?

Swadeshi's Scions

If this was the fate of the steamers, what of the many who gave their everything to run SSNCo?

VOC's life after SSNCo is for the last chapter. For all the adversities he faced, VOC at least passed into history as a tragic hero, etched in the popular mind as the epitome of patriotism and sacrifice. His colleagues and associates were not so fortunate. In my forty years of research little has turned up about his associates in SSNCo.

Luckily, some fragmentary information has come to light about S.D. Krishna Aiyangar, who helmed the company after VOC. Called as witness to the Indian Mercantile Marine Committee in January 1924, he gave a strident written statement followed by combative oral evidence—of which more below. On Vaikunta Ekadesi day, nearly three years later, in 1926, Krishna Aiyangar died suddenly even as he was singing the devotional songs of Subramania Bharati at an event organized by the Hindi Prachara Sabha, Tuticorin. Devout Vaishnavites believe that dying on that holy day provides release from the unending cycle of birth and rebirth and the soul reaches the lotus feet of Vishnu. Krishna Aiyangar's work in the cause of SSNCo would have easily qualified him for this. On his death,